



seventh ball of the day as the first-change bowler. Despite the ball being eight overs old, it still offered some movement.

Bangladesh opener Zakir Hasan had already faced three of Akash's deliveries, which tested the outside edge, but this time, Akash cocked his wrists, angled the seam into Zakir, and the wobbling ball held its line. With a front press, Zakir played straight but missed, and the ball crashed into the middle stump. Off the very next ball, Mominul Haque suffered the same fate.

Cocked wrists. Wobbled seam. Beaten. These are often associated with Mohammad Shami, but with Shami recovering from injury, Akash has stepped in with similar skills.

The 27-year-old Bengal pacer debuted against England earlier this year, quickly dismantling the top order with a mix of deliveries that either seamed away or nipped back in. Akash's deliveries mostly land on

a good length (62%) or back of a length (30.5%), keeping the stumps in play.

His unique wrist action and wobbled seam add an extra challenge for batters, as they have to guess whether the ball will straighten, seam away, or nip back in. Although he occasionally clocks 140 kmph, Akash often bowls in the high 130s, relying on deception over speed.

"Skiddy bowler. More pace than I expected. He got the ball to nip with variable bounce. It was tricky," said English opener Zak Crawley, who was bowled by Akash twice, although once off a no-ball.

With his promising start in international cricket, Akash appears to be an ideal addition to India's core fast-bowling group. His natural length, around four to five meters, aligns with what works in Australia, where 65% of deliveries have landed on a good length since 2020 and 22.5 per cent on back-of-a-length.

India's upcoming Tests against New Zealand will be an ideal setting for Akash to hone his skills before the November tour of Australia.

(Note: All stats updated till India vs Bangladesh Tests)

Lengths in Tests: In Australia since 2020 in comparison with Akash Deep

